

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, January 22, 2025, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne - Absent
Ward II Councilor Brian Zutter
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor William Greenrose – Absent
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Yoshi Manale, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

None.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept the minutes of the January 22, 2025, City Council meeting.

Change Dorchester to Rochester in the last meeting minutes, all agree with changes.

Voice vote :

Koloski – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 7-0

MAYOR'S NOTES

Claremont School District is accepting applications through January 31st for the upcoming School board elections held on March 11th. You may apply at the SAU office at 165 Broad Street from 8:00 a.m. to 4:00 p.m. Monday through Friday, on the 31st filing forms will be available between 3:00 p.m. – 5:00 p.m. that day. Three positions will be elected, the moderator, treasurer, district clerk are all 1-year terms, and then the two school board member seats are three-year seats.

Claremont school district will also have a deliberative session on Saturday February 1st at 9:00 a.m. at the Stevens High School.

Claremont Parks and Recreation will be hosting a Winter Fest January 27th through the 31st.

Claremont Parks and Recreation will also be hosting the crown point pigskin run walk on Sunday February 9th, at 11:00 a.m.

The Wall that Heals committee is meeting on Wednesday January 29th at 6pm in the Elks Club

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Warming shelter hours open to public at the Claremont Savings Bank Community Center during normal business hours, tonight and tomorrow CSBCC will open until 9:00 p.m..

Trinity Church on 120 Broad Street will be open from 9pm-8am for a warming shelter seven nights week for those who need a warm place to stay.

Department of Public Works released the upcoming spring projects for fiscal year 2025, such as the paving plan.

Parks and Recreation Department is putting an ice-skating space at Arrowhead for the Winterfest.

Happy Chinese New Year and Spring festival for the Asian community.

Councilor Koloski mentioned he noticed utilities down by the dominos intersection and had concern for work being done on the Dominos project during the Washington St. paving timeline. Manager Manale will follow up.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Mayor Girard gave reminder that Citizen's forum is designed to allow you the opportunity to make the Council aware of your concerns. Please state your name and ward number, we ask you to address your concerns directly to the Council. The Council Manager will not be responding to you during this time. You are limited to five minutes on any non-agenda items. In the back of the room please write down your contact information if you'd like to be contacted as well as your concern on the clipboard for follow up.

Cornelia Sargent, Ward II, extended gratitude to all councilors, and the zoning board of adjustments, and wants to make others aware – there is public hearing from DES on the pending proposed waste transfer station at the Claremont junction, and this is an opportunity for citizens voices to count.

James Contois, Ward II, noted in 2019 public became aware of the proposed construction and waste facility- within days there were 150 signatures of people who didn't want this facility. Mr. Contois noted this facility is an insult to the community and asked the public to show up at the public hearing and say no to this proposal.

OLD BUSINESS

None.

NEW BUSINESS

CDBG Housing Funds for Improvements at Claremont Housing Authority Marion Phillips Apartments

Mayor Girard invited Donna Lane from CDBG and Michelle Aiken from the Housing Authority, Mayor Girard also mentioned there was information in the hallway for the public.

Mayor Girard opened up a public hearing and read the following:

Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) funds are available to municipalities through the NH Community Development Finance Authority. Up to \$500,000 annually is available for Economic Development Projects, up to \$500,000 for Housing Projects, up to \$750,000 for Supportive Housing, up to \$500,000 for Public Facility Projects, up to at least \$350,000 in Emergency Funds, up to \$25,000 per Planning Study grant. All projects must directly benefit a majority of low- and moderate-income persons.

This is a proposed application to the NH Community Development Finance Authority for up to \$500,000 in CDBG Housing Funds towards improvements at the Claremont Housing Authority's property, the Marion Phillips Apartments, at 243 Broad Street, Claremont. Improvements to

include elevator improvements. All of the 96 apartments are occupied by elderly and disabled persons of extremely low and low income.

This project conforms with Claremont's Housing and Community Development Goal of: Encourage a varied stock of safe, sanitary, decent and affordable housing for persons of all age and income groups (Short- and Long-Term Goal).

Maor Girard asks for public comment.

Michelle Aiken, from Claremont Housing Authority added they are looking to upgrade the elevators out of compliance with ADA. The elevators were built in 1975 and are unable to get the components to fix because it was built so long ago.

No one else from the public spoke, Mayor Girard closed public hearing.

Motion to Submit CDBG Application for Claremont Housing Authority Marion Phillips Apartments Elevator Improvements Project.

The Claremont City Council hereby approves the submission of a Community Development Block Grant application for up to \$500,000 in housing funds (consistent with public hearing notice), toward improvements at the Claremont Housing Authority's property, at 243 Broad Street. Improvements are to include elevator improvements, and to further authorize the City Manager to sign and submit the application, and upon approval of the CDBG housing funds application, authorize the City Manager to execute any documents which may be necessary to effectuate the CDBG contract and any other amendments thereto.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Limoges to Submit CDBG Application for Claremont Housing Authority Marion Phillips Apartments Elevator Improvements Project.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 7-0

CDBG Adoption of the City's anti-displacement and Relocation Assistance Plan

Mayor Girard opens a public hearing and reads the following:

This plan outlines measures, under the Uniform Relocation Act, required for CDBG projects that involve any displacement or relocation of persons (or businesses), if the City were to undertake a CDBG project which involved displacement or relocation they would follow this plan. The plan outlines the measures they would take to find comparable, suitable housing for persons (or businesses) displaced or relocated. No relocation or displacement is anticipated.

Mayor Girard asked for public comment.

Donna Lane from CDBG noted this was project specific.

No one else from the public spoke, Mayor Girard closed public hearing.

Motion to Adopt the City's Residential Anti-Displacement and Relocation Assistance Plan – Claremont Housing Authority, 243 Broad Street

The Claremont City Council hereby moves to adopt the City's Residential Anti-Displacement and Relocation Assistance Plan for the proposed CDBG Housing funds to be used for improvements at the Claremont Housing Authority's Marion Phillips Apartments at 243 Broad Street.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to Adopt the City's Residential Anti-Displacement and Relocation Assistance Plan – Claremont Housing Authority, 243 Broad Street

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 7-0

Spring Capital Plan Discussion

Manager Manale read the spring capital memo, and noted a number of items have been vetted by our directors, and stated the directors are in attendance for any questions.

Due to prudent financial decisions by the Mayor, Assistant Mayor, and Council over the past few years, by stopping the use of non-recurring funds for annual expenses, increasing grant acquisition to offset infrastructure improvements, improving cash balances, and focusing on sustainable growth, enforcement, collection and auction of prior delinquent tax accounts, the city of Claremont has for the first time in a long time in a financially sound space to invest and make capital improvements into the city without adding to its debt service. In FY25 the city has already added over \$2.4 million in funds to the road and sidewalk infrastructure, including \$1.2 million for the full replacement of Washington St in the Spring. Compare this to 2019, when the city only invested \$220k and \$12k toward road and sidewalk improvements. We have invested \$800k in new park improvements, including a new dog park and, starting this spring, new pickleball and tennis courts, and made significant fixes to city-owned buildings. We have done this by not using unassigned fund balances to artificially lower the tax rate or one-time funds to pay for recurring costs. Instead, we have focused on grants, finding creative use of one-time funds to help us get additional federal/state aid, and only spending what we have.

As noted in the FY2023 audit, the city had **\$5,331,825** in unassigned fund balance. With the recent update to the fund balance policy, the city is encouraged to keep a maximum of 15% of the city's budgeted expenditure in reserve. For FY2025, that would be **\$2,938,766**. The recent allocation of **\$1,246,430** for the repaving of Washington Street leaves **\$1,146,629** in unassigned fund balance for the city to use for non-reoccurring expenditures. In addition, because of a successful auction this past year, the city has **\$1,028,323** in the Capital Reserve Fund for Code Enforcement and Capital Improvements (CRF) created by the council to fund capital improvements, code enforcement, and grant match needs. The council traditionally sets capital expenditures during the FY26 budget; however, as the city already has the funds in its accounts, the finance director and I felt the council should consider expending some of those funds on current spending needs.

Before you, you will find a list of items and projects the directors, and I have vetted, most of which you will find in the 2023 capital improvement plan, that our staff feels they can oversee and complete by the end of the fiscal year. Highlights include updating the 2017 parking study and conducting a downtown traffic study, making improvements to various parking areas in the city that need new lining and paving, the first phase of the police bathroom replacement and breathing apparatus needed for our firefighters, and a set-aside for the pending Eversource litigation. In addition, we have match payments for grants that leverage our fund balance to get additional grant funds. Any funds not spent would fall back to the unassigned fund balance.

This expenditure will not impact the tax rate as the city already has the funds.

Parking Lot Paving and Re-lining – DPW (\$100,000)

Several parking lots in our downtown area require paving and re-lining for more efficient spacing.

Downtown Parking and Traffic Study – Planning (\$25,000)

We are requesting funding to conduct a comprehensive traffic and parking assessment of the City Center area. As Claremont continues to change and grow, concerns about traffic flow, safety, and parking availability have been raised by residents, business owners, and City officials. The city would like to partner with transportation planners from the Upper Valley Lake Sunapee Regional Planning Commission to develop and conduct this project, which will have two major parts.

Traffic Flow Analysis: Examining the flow of traffic in our City Center to determine an optimal circulation pattern. This analysis will help us identify critical areas where safety and efficiency improvements can be made.

Parking Improvements: Developing a plan to reconfigure and re-line parking spaces in the City Center to better address current and future parking needs.

A proper study will be a foundational step for responsible infrastructure improvements and guide us in making informed capital investments that benefit the entire community.

Downtown Beautification – Parks and Recreation (\$20,000)

Pole lighting will be going up, and more electrical boxes will need to be fixed/installed on Opera House Square in the coming weeks. The pole lighting will extend down Pleasant Street. Pole lights have been purchased; we are working with staff and volunteers to get these up this winter. The plan for the lights in the center of Opera House and Pleasant Street is to be left up year-round. We are waiting to test all the current electrical boxes to see where we can have the electrician focus on his time.

Looking ahead to the Spring and Summer, we plan to add additional infrastructure in the center of Opera House Square, where the trees are located. We also plan to help coordinate the flower boxes

along Pleasant Street. This will be a joint effort between Planning & Development and Parks and Recreation.

This is part of our initiative to maintain a beautiful downtown area, encouraging new businesses to open and residents to frequent our downtown businesses.

Barnes Park Grandstand Demolition – Parks and Recreation (\$40,000)

The city proposes to remove and dispose of the grandstands at Barnes Park while preserving the park's maintenance shop and bathrooms below. The scope of work includes:

- Remove the associated electrical in and attached to the grandstand area.
- Relocate the building lighting.
- Remove and replace the fencing between the grandstand and the backstop.
- Remove and dispose of the grandstand

Last year, a fire on the grandstands caused some damage. We are fortunate that our fire department was alerted quickly and was able to minimize the fire. We have an insurance claim of \$7,602 that will be used toward the removal and disposal of the grandstand. A complete replacement of the grandstand would be in the range of \$200,000-300,000.

Through the CIP process, plans will be proposed to replace the grandstand with alternative seating.



Synergy Site Green Space/Beautification – DPW/Parks and Rec (\$80,000)

In anticipation of a possible ADA ramp from the upper visitor's center green to the synergy site, DPW is clearing brush and managing trees in the area overlooking the Sugar River. Tree work, such as pruning and selective removal, will open scenic views of the river, enhance safety, and promote the health of remaining trees. Removing overgrown brush improves accessibility and creates a cleaner, more inviting environment. In addition, when we get the go-ahead from DES, we plan to lay down a new layer of nutrient-rich soil and plant durable grass to foster a lush, comfortable surface for walking, sitting, and gathering on the green. This effort beautifies the

space and establishes new community space, setting the stage for future outdoor activities and events while connecting visitors and residents with the natural beauty of the Sugar River.

City Hall Window Replacement Bond – Planning (\$9,000)

We are seeking additional funds for our contractor, Jacob's Glass, to furnish Payment and Performance Bonds. Initially, we did not include these in the project's cost to maximize the LCHIP Grant funding we received. It was brought to our attention that RSA: 447:16 requires bonds on projects over \$125,000. Therefore,

We need these additional funds to pay for the bond to maintain the same number of windows replaced with the grant.

Police Bathroom Replacement – Police (\$103,000)

The police department plans to replace the existing three shower stalls in the second-floor locker rooms (and convert them into two ADA-compliant stalls), three sinks, and two urinals. The goal is to drain the plumbing fixtures properly and conserve water usage. Similarly, in the women's locker room, we're looking to replace the existing shower stall to make it ADA-compliant, replace the two existing toilets, and make the drain correctly and conserve water more efficiently. This project is also a high priority for the police department because the existing locker room facilities are laden with rust (and possibly mold), and the drains are malfunctioning. At times, the water runs continuously.

FY24 Legal Fee payment and code enforcement legal funds increase – Legal (\$35,000)

In November of this year, we received a bill of \$23,000 from Drummond Woodson for services provided in the FY24 budget. The funds allocated for these services were in the FY24 budget; however, they were not encumbered because we had not yet received billing. This additional legal expense was not anticipated in the FY25 budget. In addition, the city has aggressively targeted those violating building and fire codes and taking them to court. We need an additional \$12,000 toward legal code enforcement

actions in anticipation of continued enforcement action. When the city has a favorable judgment, we receive back legal fees, which are then dropped back into the fund balance as revenue.

FY24 Southwest Community Service Marketing Budget – Planning (\$10,000)

Like the FY24 Legal fees, this bill for bus wraps on southwest community service buses was not paid in FY24 and was not budgeted for in our FY25 marketing budget. It was budgeted for in FY24, but it was not spent.

Fire Department Self-Contained Breathing Apparatus Replacement – Fire (\$100,000)

The Self-Contained Breathing Apparatus (SCBA) is among our most critical equipment. These devices enable us to suppress fire (interior and exterior operations) and respond to incidents

involving compromised air quality, such as carbon monoxide emergencies, odor investigations, and confined space entries.

Our department currently maintains 42 SCBAs, which are distributed throughout our apparatus. Per NFPA standards, SCBAs have a life expectancy of 15 years, and it is also considered best practice to stay within two standard technology cycles for this equipment.

Of our 42 units:

- 14 have exceeded the 15-year life expectancy and cannot be repaired due to the unavailability of replacement parts.
- 28 are 10 years old and approaching the end of their service life.

The plan is to purchase 10 new SCBA units that meet current technological standards, ensuring our personnel's safety and operational needs.

Eversource Litigation – Assessing (\$250,000)

There has been a long-running property tax appeal involving several tax years between the Public Service Company of NH (d/b/a Eversource) and the City of Claremont pending in the Superior Court. The cases began in 2019 and have involved dozens of communities in New Hampshire. The cases have been consolidated for hearing, and the City has retained an appraiser to defend the assessments. The Hearing for these cases is expected to begin later this year. While the prospects for the cases are good, there is never any certainty in legal action. This is especially true in property tax appeals that involve differing market value opinions. Planning for a negative outcome is prudent preparation. The amount of \$250,000 has been added to the overlay in tax year 2023 and tax year 2024 in anticipation of a negative result. It is recommended that a total amount of \$1M, including the 2023 and 2024 overlay amounts, in

the event the court finds in favor of Eversource. Should the court find in favor of the City, any monies set aside for this purpose would lapse into the general fund unassigned balance.

Cybersecurity Audit – IT (\$15,000)

We have made a few IT security improvements with our city-owned systems over the past year, including implementing multi-factor authentication and security hardware tokens, migrating to more secure remote access protocols, and performing security audits. We plan to increase our IT security investment further this coming year. The need to increase our security is partly brought about by the increase in usage of cloud-based resources, which adds an increased level of threat visibility due to their ability to be potentially accessed remotely by threat actors. The initial items that we are planning on focusing on include more advanced in-depth security audits, increasing security monitoring mechanisms, including utilizing external security monitoring organizations, investigating increased cloud-based risk due to new AI tools, and upgrading to a

premium version of Microsoft Cloud access to allow more in-depth configuration, monitoring, and reporting.

Body Worn Camera Match – Police (\$40,000)

The Body-Worn Camera System is to fund the direct match associated with the Small, Rural, Tribal Body-Worn Camera (SRTBWC) grant that the City of Claremont received in the amount of \$40,000. There is a 100% match of the funds provided to us by the federal government. The Claremont Police Department wishes to replace our existing Body-Worn Camera system as well as our in-car camera system, both of which are at the end of life and in desperate need of repair. This is a critical improvement for the police department (highest priority), as the system is malfunctioning. Poor or inoperable digital evidence systems have deleterious effects on the prosecution of criminal cases. Further, failure to make the improvements could degrade public confidence in the Claremont Police Department.

Citywide Paving – DPW (\$TBD)

Additional side street paving work. If it chooses, the council can add extra money to complete the paving this Spring. However, we suggest adding additional paving expenditures during the FY26 budget discussion.

Audit 2024 – Finance (\$35,000)

The City's FY2024 fiscal year records were not auditable at the commencement of the audit. Accordingly, Vachon Clukay & Company PC, our financial audit firm, estimates additional costs of

\$30,000 to \$35,000 to complete the FY2024 audit. These extra fees, combined with the \$34,500 contracted amount, will result in a low-end total of \$64,500 in audit fees for FY2024. It is worth noting that the additional fees include a generous 30% write-off of the actual costs incurred by Vachon Clukay

& Company PC. The Finance Department respectfully requests additional appropriation to cover FY2024 audit costs.

Significant changes have been and are being made in the Finance Department to ensure the FY2025 audit will be more efficient and require fewer audit resources.

Daddy's Pizza Alleyway Lights – Planning (\$3,700)

We are seeking funds to install two lights and wiring in the alleyway connecting the Municipal Lot on Broad Street to Pleasant Street. This work was also promised during the Pleasant Street 2022 project.

Broad Street Municipal Lot Goddard Block Signs – Planning (\$10,000)

When the City repaved and restriped the Broad Street Municipal Lot, there were seven signs removed to do the work, and it was promised in 2022 to the Goddard Block by Project Manager Mike McCrory at the time that these signs were to be reinstalled. We are seeking additional funding to furnish and install these signs back to where they belong.

Visitor Center Heating and A/C – Planning (\$60,000)

The plan is to fix the three attic units in the Visitor's Center attic and replace the three exterior condensers. Last year, we replaced the boiler in the building, which mostly fixed the heating problem. Once we complete the project with these six units, we will continue to fix the heating problem upstairs, resolving the central air conditioning problem throughout the building.

The 2025-2030 Capital Improvement Plan proposed adding ductless heat pumps to all four offices and the downstairs and upstairs open areas. We want to modify this plan for increased efficiency and avoid needing extensive exterior ductwork.

Wall the Heals – Council (\$2,500)

The city is set to host the Wall the Heals, a replica of the Vietnam War memorial in Washington, DC, in Monadnock Park in 2025. The city is helping with the costs of hosting the wall and security; however, the council may want to allocate additional funds for the project.

SPRING CAPITAL PLAN		Requesting Department	SOURCE
<i>Parking Re-line and Paving</i>	\$ 100,000	DPW	CRF
<i>Downtown Parking & Traffic Study</i>	\$ 25,000	Planning	FB
<i>Downtown Beautification</i>	\$ 20,000	Planning	CRF
<i>Synergy Site Improvements</i>	\$ 80,000	DPW/Parks and Rec	CRF
<i>Barnes Park Grandstand Removal</i>	\$ 40,000	Parks and Rec	CRF
<i>City Hall Window Replacement - bond</i>	\$ 9,000	Planning	FB
<i>Police Bathroom Replacement</i>	\$ 103,000	Police	CRF
<i>FY24 Legal Fees</i>	\$ 35,000	Legal	FB
<i>FY24 Southwest Community Bus Marketing</i>	\$ 10,000	Planning	FB
<i>Eversource Litigation</i>	\$ 250,000	Assessing	FB
<i>Cybersecurity Audit</i>	\$ 15,000	IT	FB
<i>Body Worn Camera match</i>	\$ 40,000	Police	CRF
<i>Breathing Apparatus</i>	\$ 100,000	Fire	CRF
<i>Audit 2024</i>	\$ 35,000	Finance	FB
<i>Daddy's Pizza Alleyway Lights</i>	\$ 3,700	Planning	CRF
<i>Goddard Block Signs</i>	\$ 10,000	Planning	CRF

<i>Visitor Center HVAC replacement</i>	\$ 80,000	Planning	CRF
<i>CityWide Paving</i>	TBD		FB
<i>Wall that Heals</i>	\$ 2,500	Council	FB
TOTAL	\$ 958,200		

Capital Reserve Fund (CRF) \$ **576,700**
Unreserved Fund Balance (FB) \$ **386,200**

Funds available for FY26 capital expenditure:

Capital Reserve Fund (Note: Additional Capital reserve funds will be available after the Spring tax deeded property auction.) – \$451,623

Unreserved Fund Balance (Note: Additional unreserved fund balance will be available for FY26 after the FY2024 audit is complete.) - \$760,429

Mayor Girard suggested going from top down for discussion on this list, and asked for questions on the first five projects listed.

Manager Manale reminded all that the money that is allocated to these projects – anything that is not expended falls back into those accounts.

Councilor Koloski asked if there are maps of areas for parking lot paving and relining for certain areas.

Director Gleeson noted there will be a City wide study for parking, relining, and paving.

Mayor Girard asked if the parking lot on the pleasant street side of building is city property.

Director Gleeson explained he will get back with actual square footage.

Director Gleeson also explained the study will look at all of downtown not just the two lots to see if the City can optimize spaces.

Councilor Zutter stated he would be more aligned on using the \$25,000 on parking improvements.

Councilor Koloski feels this is too vague, and suggested the goal be to address school district parking.

Barnes Park grand stand removal-

Mayor Girard noted this is a concern whether it can be rehabbed or if it has to come down.

Manager Manale stated there was an analysis done, and if the City wants to fix or replace it would be \$200K. The existing structure isn't good enough to repair. Still waiting to find out if insurance money will cover the fire repairs.

Councilor Limoges clarified this is considered an unsafe structure, Manager Manale stated yes, and it has been closed for years.

Councilor Koloski wants the Parks and Recreation Committee to come back with a recommendation.

Councilor Zutter agrees, and wants to encourage citizens to come out and talk about it. Council agrees to remove this for now.

Southwest Services

Manager Manale noted the City currently pays for bus wraps and we were billed for 2024 and it needs to be paid, it was already budgeted.

Police Bathroom Replacement

Mayor Girard asked Chief Wilmot why are we over \$100K for bathrooms.

Chief Wilmot said the this was the quote from plumbing and contracting. However, there is room to shrink.

Manager Manale reminded again that anything not spent will drop back into fund balance.

Councilor Hayden wants to understand the real price, Manager Manale said we have two weeks and can come back with another price.

Councilor Hemingway asked if the body cam match was part of their operating budget when we approved this grant.

Chief Wilmot noted the body worn camera grant match and explained coming back during budget, we would still have costs above and beyond this number but this would at least cover the entire grant match.

Mayor Girard asked if this covers all the cameras. Chief Wilmot noted he is looking to replace both body worn and mounted cameras.

Chief Wilmot also explained that the top two vendors do a refresh; so, at end of life a whole new set of cameras will be replaced at no additional cost.

Daddys Pizza

Councilor Zutter questioned Daddys pizza lights, Manager Manale explained this is an obligation.

Goddard Block Signs

Councilor Hemingway questioned if the Goddard Block signs could have been saved and stated it was a lot of money to be replacing signs.

Project Manager Avery Hallbauer stated this number was based on the signs no longer being there because when he and one other co-worker went to find these signs, they were no longer there. Since then, signs have been found, there are only five and believes this number can now drop to about \$6,000 instead of \$10,000.

Council agrees to drop this to \$6,000.

Wall that Heals

Mayor Girard thinks the City should help with fundraising.

Councilor Limoges noted the fee is \$12,000, and \$3500 has already paid, and a total overall budget of \$50,000.

Councilor Koloski wants more money added to this, Councilor Zutter suggested \$12,000.

Manager Manale wanted to clarify that Councilor Limoges did not request this, and the price was put in there as a place holder.

Hemingway suggested adding the \$4,000 from the signs.

Mayor Girard suggested \$8,500 to get the fee to \$12,000 with their already donated \$3500.

Council agrees to change this to \$8,500.

City Wide Paving

Assistant Mayor Matteau wants to put \$200,000 because it's a big issue in the community.

Councilor Zutter suggested a set number every year.

Manager Manale stated the City sets a minimum of \$500K and that is considered to maintain as is, if council wants beyond this.

Councilor Hayden asked if this money is for paving and infrastructure. Director Gleeson noted it would be for paving.

Council agrees to add \$200,000.

Audit 2024

Councilor Koloski shared concern about switching auditing firms after a period of time.

Director Bates explained the years on contract end with this audit, and noted the team always changes, Director Bates did not want to change that this year because of position she's in being new but can look at this in the future.

Mayor Girard asked how the City needs another \$35,000.

Director Bates stated its due to pushing forward expense's, auditors had to do a lot more work because many items weren't in auditable condition. This is something she is focusing on changing next year, and wants this information in the budget books so Council can have this information going into budget discussions.

Mayor Girard asked if there were any other items Council would like to add to the list.

Councilor Koloski shared concern about the sloping foundation on the ground floor of the Visitors Center, and suggested adding it to the CIP.

Manager Manale stated this could be a great item to add for FY 2026 if it's determined to be a priority.

Mayor Girard suggested adding a line item with capital money for grant matching funds. Manager Manale stated this was an intention.

Mayor Girard Brought up the Fire Department ramp and rehabilitation, and asked Chief Chamberlain when the last time that area was paved. Chief Chamberlain replied in the last 18 years he has been there it has not been fully paved, and even spoke to a previous chief who had been there for almost forty years they also could not recall when there was a full pave.

Mayor Girard asked that this is looked at from a safety standpoint and the weight of the fire trucks aren't getting lighter.

Mayor Girard brought up the Monadnock Park Track, and according to the CIP it says we are supposed to resurface this in every 10 -15 years, and thinks we may be past that mark, Manager Manale will look into that.

Mayor Girard also brought up the library shelving, Director Grace stated it should be done in 2025/2026.

Mayor Girard has concerns about the roof. Director Grace stated it's the original roof, its old, its over 100 years old, and dealing with small leaks; its well past its lifespan.

Mayor Girard also brought up the Coy bridge; the CIP shows it on 25/26 list, but does not seem on DOT red list.

Mayor Girard also brought forward security upgrades.

Manager Manale stated the City is still vetting and the Police Department is still adding items, so wants to move it as we don't have the full cost.

The next item Mayor Girard brought up was sewer remediation for City Hall.

Manager Manale noted this is a long-time issue and is hoping to leverage the CDBG program to help with costs.

Mayor Girard asked for \$200K set aside for grant matches in an escrow account, \$250,000 put aside for the Fire Department parking lot paving, \$64,000 for the track, and would like to see the library roof get completed which is about \$125,000.

Manager Manale stated these all need project management, and has a concern with capacity, and reminded all that this money should at the very least be contracted by end of June.

Assistant Mayor Matteau agrees with matching grants account, but doesn't feel like the roof and ramp will be done quickly enough and feels this can be rolled over until next year. Assistant Mayor Matteau does agree with the track.

SPRING CAPITAL PLAN		Requesting Department	SOURCE
<i>Parking Re-line and Paving</i>	\$ 100,000	DPW	CRF
<i>Downtown Parking & Traffic Study</i>	\$ 25,000	Planning	FB
<i>Downtown Beautification</i>	\$ 20,000	Planning	CRF
<i>Synergy Site Improvements</i>	\$ 80,000	DPW/Parks and Rec	CRF
<i>Barnes Park Grandstand Removal</i>	\$ 40,000	Parks and Rec	CRF
<i>City Hall Window Replacement - bond</i>	\$ 9,000	Planning	FB
<i>Police Bathroom Replacement</i>	\$ 103,000	Police	CRF
<i>FY24 Legal Fees</i>	\$ 35,000	Legal	FB
<i>FY24 Southwest Community Bus Marketing</i>	\$ 10,000	Planning	FB
<i>Eversource Litigation</i>	\$ 250,000	Assessing	FB
<i>Cybersecurity Audit</i>	\$ 15,000	IT	FB
<i>Body Worn Camera match</i>	\$ 40,000	Police	CRF
<i>Breathing Apparatus</i>	\$ 100,000	Fire	CRF
<i>Audit 2024</i>	\$ 35,000	Finance	FB
<i>Daddy's Pizza Alleyway Lights</i>	\$ 3,700	Planning	CRF
<i>Goddard Block Signs</i>	\$ 10,000 6,000	Planning	CRF
<i>Visitor Center HVAC replacement</i>	\$ 80,000	Planning	CRF
<i>CityWide Paving</i>	TBD 200,000		FB
<i>Wall that Heals</i>	\$ 2,500 8500	Council	FB
TOTAL	\$ 958,200		

<u>Capital Reserve Fund (CRF)</u>	\$ 576,700
<u>Unreserved Fund Balance (FB)</u>	\$ 386,200

Funds available for FY26 capital expenditure:

Capital Reserve Fund (Note: Additional Capital reserve funds will be available after the Spring tax deeded property auction.) – \$451,623

Unreserved Fund Balance (Note: Additional unreserved fund balance will be available for FY26 after the FY2024 audit is complete.) - \$760,429

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Councilor Koloski noted the Arts Committee is still engaging in conversation with colleges and universities for an intern, and selected a location at visitors center to display items that City owns.

Assistant Mayor Matteau noted the Planning Board approved an ADU on Bond St., and driveway regulations moved to next meeting. Also noted the chicken meeting went well.

Councilor Zutter added the CCTV Committee elected officers and reviewed 2025 goals.

Councilor Hemingway reported the Policy committee is reviewing bicycles.

Councilor Hayden reported the Conservation Commission reviewed annual elections.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Koloski asked when the City should start pushing education to the public on the charter vote.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 8:52 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Zutter to adjourn.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Zutter – yes

Hayden – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council